

# Jake's Table Cooking Class Syllabus

East Lake, Atlanta | Home Kitchen Studio | Capacity: 8 Students

Jake's Table offers hands-on cooking classes from a home kitchen in East Lake, Atlanta. Classes are taught by Jake Thornton - CNM by profession, home cook and cooking instructor by passion. The kitchen uses a six-burner gas range, a wood-burning outdoor grill, and five backyard raised beds that supply fresh herbs and seasonal produce to the class kitchen throughout the growing season.

## Class Philosophy

The goal at Jake's Table is not to produce restaurant-quality plating - it is to build cooking confidence that translates directly to a home kitchen. Every technique demonstrated in class is chosen because it is repeatable on standard home equipment. Students leave with a recipe card, a technique note card, and the ability to reproduce the dish the following weekend.

Classes run in small groups of no more than eight students. This is deliberate. At eight people, everyone gets time at the stove. Everyone makes the sauce. Everyone plates their own dish. The shared meal at the end of each class is as much a part of the learning as the cooking itself.

## Track 1 - Southern Comfort Foundations

The Southern Comfort track covers the core techniques of American Southern cooking: roux-based sauces, braising, one-pot cooking, and roasting. Sessions are taught in a recommended sequence but can be taken independently.

| Session | Recipe                      | Key Techniques                                 |
|---------|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| SC-1    | Smoked Gouda Mac and Cheese | Béchamel, cheese sauce, pasta technique        |
| SC-2    | Buttermilk Roast Chicken    | Brining, roasting, pan sauce from drippings    |
| SC-3    | Chicken and Okra Gumbo      | Dark roux, trinity, one-pot building           |
| SC-4    | Andouille Jambalaya         | Blond roux, layered seasoning, rice absorption |

## Track 2 - American Fusion

The Fusion track focuses on technique cross-over: applying classical French and Latin techniques to American ingredients and flavor profiles.

| Session | Recipe                                | Key Techniques                                 |
|---------|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| AF-1    | Hearty Beef Stew with Root Vegetables | Sonnd, braising liquid, long simmer            |
| AF-2    | Grilled Ribeye with Herb Butter       | Compound butter, fire management, resting      |
| AF-3    | Seared Duck Breast with Peach Glaze   | Skin rendering, reduction sauce, plating       |
| AF-4    | Whole Roasted Fish with Herb Crust    | Scoring, cavity seasoning, doneness by texture |

## Track 3 - Grilling Intensive

The Grilling Intensive is taught at the outdoor kitchen during grilling season (typically April through October in Atlanta, with pop-up indoor sessions in November and December).

| Session | Focus                       | Key Skills                                       |
|---------|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| GI-1    | Fire and Steak Fundamentals | Two-zone fire, two-zone cooking, doneness        |
| GI-2    | Chicken and Pork on Fire    | Brining, spatchcocking, indirect finish          |
| GI-3    | Seafood and Vegetables      | Oiling grates, delicate proteins, plank grilling |
| GI-4    | Full Menu Grill Class       | Sequencing, timing multiple proteins, sauces     |

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### Three-Hour Session Arc

| Time      | Activity                                                     |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0:00-0:05 | Welcome and introductions - meet your fellow students        |
| 0:05-0:15 | Knife safety brief and station orientation                   |
| 0:15-0:45 | Instructor demo: technique walk-through for the session dish |
| 0:45-2:15 | Hands-on cooking - students cook in pairs or individually    |
| 2:15-2:30 | Plating and photography - present your dish                  |
| 2:30-2:50 | Shared meal, Q&A, and technique debrief                      |
| 2:50-3:00 | Cleanup, recipe cards, and scheduling next session           |

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### Registration and Scheduling

**Class schedule:** Two to three sessions per month, Saturday or Sunday afternoons starting at 2:00 PM. The schedule for each month is posted in the first week of the prior month.

**Registration:** All classes require advance registration. A non-refundable deposit of \$25 (applied to the class fee) is required to hold a spot. Class fees range from \$75 to \$95 per person depending on the session. The full balance is due 48 hours before class.

**Cancellation policy:** Cancellations more than 72 hours before class receive a full credit toward a future session (deposit retained). Cancellations within 72 hours forfeit the full class fee. Jake's Table reserves the right to cancel a session if enrollment falls below four students, with full refunds issued.

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### House Rules

- Closed-toe shoes required in the kitchen at all times.
- Knife skills are demonstrated before any cutting begins - please wait for the demo.
- Disclose all food allergies and dietary restrictions at registration. Menus can be adjusted with advance notice.
- The kitchen is a shared space - clean as you go.
- Children under 14 are not permitted in class sessions.

- No outside food or drink except water bottles.